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Tremor stabilization apparatus and methods

Abstract

The present invention relates to improvements in or relating to tremor stabilisation apparatus and methods, in particular to gyroscopic devices for use in controlling tremors of parts of the body and for reducing effects of tremors on the human body. The apparatus includes a wearable element and at least one gyroscopic device mounted or mountable to the wearable element, the gyroscopic device including a gyroscope and a gyroscope housing. The at least one gyroscopic device may be mounted within the housing such that the gyroscope may precess with respect to the housing. The mount may include a hinge to which the gyroscope is mounted and a hinge plate or hinge mount to which the hinge is mounted for rotation with respect to the gyroscope housing, such as a turntable mounted to the gyroscope housing. The gyroscopic devices may include a control arrangement to control the precession of the gyroscope.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 15/539,089, filed Jun. 22, 2017, which is 35 U.S.C. 371 national stage application of PCT International Patent Application No. PCT/GB2015/054128, filed Dec. 22, 2015, which claims the benefit of and priority to GB Patent Application No. 1422899.3, filed Dec. 22, 2014. The contents of each of these applications are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety into this disclosure.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates to improvements in or relating to tremor stabilisation apparatus and methods, in particular to gyroscopic devices for use in controlling tremors of parts of the body, both physiological and pathological, especially the hands.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

(2) Involuntary muscle tremors occur in a range of neurological conditions, notably degenerative conditions such as Parkinson's disease.

(3) Numerous proposals for mediating hand tremors using gyroscopes have been proposed. U.S. Pat. No. 5,058,571 describes an early proposal in which a battery-driven gyroscope is held against the back face of the hand by a strap. A gyroscope seeks to maintain the orientation of its spinning

axis and resists any action that seeks to cause a change in that orientation. Thus, the theory of using a gyroscope is that the onset of a muscle tremor causes a movement in the hand but the gyroscope acts against that movement, substantially cancelling out the tremor.

(4) However, as noted in U.S. Pat. No. 6,730,049, the device of U.S. Pat. No. 5,058,571, having a single gyroscope, is capable only of reducing involuntary movement in one planar direction.

However, involuntary movements are rarely one-dimensional with respect to arm movement. U.S. Pat. No. 6,730,049 proposes a splint to bind the user's lower arm, wrist and hand, leaving just the thumb and fingers free. Thus, any involuntary movement within the bound area, irrespective of dimension, is transferred to the splint. A gyroscope is mounted to the splint in such a position that it counters this movement. In some embodiments, two gyroscopes are mounted to the splint with their rotational axes mounted orthogonally to one another. The device is claimed to be tuneable to a particular patient's tremor profile by adjustment of the location of the gyroscope along the length of the splint.

(5) However, the skilled person will immediately appreciate that this device prevents all free movement within the lower arm other than of the fingers. Even movement of the thumb is considerably restricted, severely limiting the patient's range of activities, potentially exacerbating the practical consequences of the patient's condition rather than alleviating it.

(6) Accordingly, there is a need for improved tremor stabilisation techniques.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(7) In its broadest sense, the present invention provides an apparatus for reducing effects of tremors on the human body. The apparatus comprises a wearable element and at least one gyroscopic device mounted or mountable to the wearable element, the gyroscopic device comprising a gyroscope and a gyroscope housing. The apparatus is characterised in that the at least one gyroscopic device is mounted within the housing by means of a mount which allows the gyroscope to precess with respect to the housing.

(8) In one embodiment, the mount comprises a hinge to which the gyroscope is mounted and a hinge plate or hinge mount to which the hinge is mounted for rotation with respect to the gyroscope housing.

(9) Preferably the hinge plate or hinge mount comprises a turntable mounted to the gyroscope housing.

(10) Preferably, the or each gyroscopic device further comprises a control arrangement to control the precession of the gyroscope.

(11) In certain embodiments, the control arrangement comprises a plurality of elastomeric dampers.

(12) Additionally, or alternatively, the control arrangement comprises a magnetic control arrangement, preferably comprising at least one magnetic disc or annular magnet associated with the gyroscope.

(13) Suitably, the control arrangement includes a motor, preferably a stepped motor, and drive arrangement associated with the turntable, preferably a direct drive arrangement, such as a gear assembly, or a belt drive arrangement.

(14) In one embodiment, the apparatus comprises a plurality of gyroscopic devices. Preferably, the plurality of gyroscopic devices are distributed across a surface or surfaces of the wearable element.

(15) Preferably, the gyroscope housing includes a switchable control circuit controlling the operation of the or each gyroscope. More preferably, the control circuit includes a switch mounted to the gyroscope housing.

(16) Preferably, the apparatus further comprises a battery power supply, preferably a rechargeable battery power supply, more preferably, a rechargeable battery power supply system rechargeable by a near-field wireless or induction charging system.

(17) Preferably, the gyroscopic devices are powered wirelessly and the apparatus further comprises a wireless power control circuit.

(18) Preferably, the wearable element is a glove, sock, shoe, strap or headgear.

- (19) Preferably, the apparatus further comprises at least one of: an accelerometer; one or more sensors, including fall sensors, sleep sensors, body metrics sensors such as blood pressure, pulse, temperature, skin conductivity and sweat sensors.
- (20) Optionally, the apparatus further includes a voice-recognition control system.
- (21) Preferably, the or each gyroscopic device includes a gyroscope disc having a plurality of radially directed lines of weakness formed therein.
- (22) Preferably, each gyroscopic device has a gyroscope disc formed with a plurality of radial fingers. More preferably, a radial length of each finger is adjustable.
- (23) Preferably, each gyroscopic device has a gyroscope disc driven by a motor and wherein the apparatus further comprises adjustment means for adjusting or modulating a current through the motor or voltage applied to the motor.
- (24) Preferably, the apparatus further comprises a global positioning system and tracking functionality.
- (25) Preferably, the apparatus further comprises wireless networking functionality linkable to external computer-based systems, such as computers, including remote computers, and mobile devices such as smartphones, laptops and tablet devices.
- (26) Preferably, the apparatus further comprises a heat-management arrangement, to remove heat generated by the gyroscopic devices.
- (27) In some embodiments, the heat management arrangement comprises the use of a heat-conductive casing to the gyroscopic devices. The heat management arrangement may also comprise a heat sink, optionally a heat sink forming a part of a casing to the gyroscopic devices. In preferred embodiments, heat recovered from the gyroscopic device is channelled to the wearable element to provide a heating function.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The above and other aspects of the present invention will now be described in further detail, by way of example only, with reference to the accompanying figures, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of an apparatus in accordance with the present invention in attached to a hand;
- (3) FIG. 2 is an exploded view of the gyroscope and gyroscope housing of the embodiment of FIG. 1;
- (4) FIGS. 3A, 3B and 3C are cross-sectional views of the gyroscope and housing of the embodiment of FIG. 1;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a graph illustrating the performance of the embodiment of FIG. 1;
- (6) FIGS. 5A, 5B and 5C are perspective views of a further embodiment of an apparatus in accordance with the present invention in the form of a glove.
- (7) FIG. 6 shows, in several view, a further alternative gyroscope disc arrangement;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a yet further embodiment of an apparatus in accordance with the present invention in the form of a glove;
- (9) FIGS. 8 to 13 show schematic views of several alternative gyroscope assemblies.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (10) A gyroscope is a device having a rotatable disc which is freely rotatable about an axis. As the disc rotates, the gyroscope will resist the action of an applied couple and tends to maintain a fixed orientation. If the gyroscope is rotationally displaced, angular momentum is conserved through nutation of the device about an axis which is mutually perpendicular to the axis of disc rotation and the axis through which the device is displaced.
- (11) A gyroscope will exert a gyroscopic moment which is proportional in magnitude to the

moment of inertia of the disc, the angular velocity of the disc and the angular velocity of nutation. The direction vector of the gyroscopic moment is proportional to the vector cross product of the angular velocity of the disc and the angular velocity of the nutation of the device.

(12) The apparatus of the present invention includes a plurality of gyroscopic devices spaced about the part of the body to which the apparatus is applied. The plurality of gyroscopic devices together apply a cumulative net gyroscopic moment to the body when the state of equilibrium of the body is perturbed, such as during a tremor or rotational displacement, but allows for the use of smaller gyroscopes, thereby spreading the mass of the gyroscopes across the body part making the device easier to wear and also reducing the bulk of the apparatus, thereby hindering dexterity and movement to a lesser degree than with known devices with larger gyroscopes.

(13) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of an apparatus in accordance with the present invention in the form of a glove **10** having a gyroscopic device **11** mounted thereto on the back of a hand **12**. In the embodiment shown, glove **10** is of the open or fingerless type to allow free-movement of the fingers **13** and thumb **14**. Preferably, the glove is formed as a fabric support for the gyroscopic device, attachable to the wrist, fingers and thumb of the wearer by means of straps, suitably straps using a hook and loop-type adjustable securing arrangement. The fabric is preferably of a soft, comfortable material that it can be worn comfortably for extended periods of time. In preferred embodiments, the fabric is of the type described in WO 2014/127291 in which van der Waals forces are developed between a soft silicone fabric surface and a wearer's skin, to retain the fabric in place.

(14) FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective of a preferred embodiment of a gyroscopic device. The gyroscope includes a rotatable disc **20**, suitably a metal disc, such as a brass disc, driven by a brushless DC motor **21**. In the embodiment shown, the gyroscope is driven by a small DC power supply in the form of batteries **22** controlled by control circuit **23**. In alternative arrangements, the power supply and control circuit are remote from the gyroscope device.

(15) Motor **21** of the gyroscope is mounted to a gyroscope table **24** which is, in turn, mounted to a precession hinge **25**, mounted to a hinge plate **30**. Hinge plate **30** is mounted to a turntable **31** which is, in turn, fixedly secured to glove **10** of the apparatus. Thus, in use, the axis of the gyroscope is able to precess by virtue of the two-axis anchoring provided by the combination of the precession hinge **25** and turntable **31**.

(16) Precession, and controlled precession of the gyroscope axis ensures that the resultant vector of resistance of the apparatus is always substantially in opposition to the tremor vector.

(17) Elastomeric dampers are provided between hinge plate **30** and gyroscope table **24** to limit the precessional angle, being the angle between the axis of precessing gyroscope and an axis normal to the hinge plate **30**.

(18) In certain embodiments, magnets are incorporated to the or each gyroscope device, either in place of the elastomeric dampers or in addition, to further control the precession of the gyroscope. For example, one or more magnetic discs or rings or a toroidal magnet are disposed about the gyroscope disc **20**, to control its precession. Alternative arrangements are equally suitable, such as springs and variable electromagnets. Additionally, orientation of the turntable can be controlled, for example by means of a stepping motor and gear arrangement, to provide further control over multiple axes of tremor with a single gyroscope.

(19) A housing **32**, attachable to the glove, encloses the gyroscope and, in the embodiment shown, provides an actuator, in the form of a switch **33**, to turn the motor on and off.

(20) FIG. 3 shows the gyroscopic device in more detail in cross-section, in both a rest orientation (FIG. 3a) and in a precessing orientation (FIG. 3b). FIG. 3c shows the inclusion of a stepped motor gear assembly to provide additional control to the turntable and thus provides additional control of precession. Alternative control systems are equally suitable, such as other direct drive assemblies or belt drive assemblies.

(21) FIG. 4 shows the results obtained with the apparatus of FIGS. 1 to 3. In the experiments, the

apparatus was attached to a wooden artist's jointed hand which was attached to a support to which a motor having a mass attached eccentrically to the spindle of the motor to induce shaking of the hand. With the apparatus attached to the hand, but not operating, a mean angular velocity magnitude of about 6 degrees per second was seen, with an amplitude from about -5.5 to $+3.5$. In contrast, with the apparatus of the present invention operating, the mean angular velocity magnitude was reduced to about 0.5 degrees per second, with an amplitude of from about -0.3 to about $+0.7$. The same performance was viewed qualitatively in a 70 year old female patient diagnosed with Parkinson's Disease and exhibiting strong hand tremors.

(22) In some embodiments, as will be described in further detail below, the gyroscope disc is integrated into the motor and acts as the motor, mounted with a permanent magnet acting as the housing.

(23) An alternative embodiment is illustrated in several views in FIGS. 5A, 5B and 5C. In this embodiment, a gyroscope mount **40** is formed within or attached to a glove element **41**. Mount **40** includes a gyroscope-receiving cup **42** for each of the plurality of gyroscopes and an associated demountable cap **43** forming a gyroscope housing for a gyroscopic device **44**. In the embodiment shown, mount **40** includes a stem **45** connecting the housing with a battery-housing **50**. Cups **42** and stem **45** can be formed integrally with the glove or formed as a demountable unit, allowing for replacement as and when necessary and allowing for the use of a single mount arrangement with a range of glove sizes or, indeed, other forms of attachment to the human body, such as straps, socks, shoes and so on.

(24) Gyroscopic device **44** includes a gyroscope disc **51** and motor **52**.

(25) Gyroscope-receiving cup **42** includes such electrical connections as are necessary for coupling the respective gyroscope to the battery supply **50**, optionally by hard-wiring of the gyroscope, but preferably by means of electrical contacts or pads within the cup against which corresponding contacts or pads upon the gyroscope unit press and are held securely in place by demountable cap **43**.

(26) With the use of a mount **40** of the type described, providing a housing individually for each gyroscope, the individual gyroscopes can be selected to provide different torques from one another if desired, for example if tremors are more prevalent in one particular area or if tremors give rise to larger effects in certain areas of the body. As such, the apparatus of the present invention can be tuned to a particular patient's needs.

(27) It will be appreciated that the gyroscopic devices need to be securely mounted to the glove or other wearable unit such that gyroscopic torque is transferred to the wearer's body rather than being absorbed by, for example, stretching or other movement of the glove. Suitable tensioning can be achieved by the use of elastic members, tensioned wires or similar arrangements; or by inclusion of such elements within the body of the wearable component.

(28) It will be appreciated that miniature gyroscopes have a considerably smaller power requirement than large gyroscopes of the type used in the prior art devices described above. Even with the use of a plurality of small gyroscopes, the total power requirement of devices of the present invention is typically considerably less than that of the prior art. As such, small, lightweight and unobtrusive button cells can be used.

(29) Alternatively, small rechargeable batteries can be used, suitably lithium ion or lithium ion polymer cells. In one arrangement, the rechargeable cells are rechargeable by means of a plug-in connector such as those that are well known in the field of electronic devices, for example, a connection attachable by means of a lead to a USB-powered connection, usually at 5 Volts (V). In alternative embodiments, the rechargeable batteries are rechargeable by means of an induction charging device. Such arrangements are well known in the field and will not be described in further detail.

(30) In a further alternative embodiment, the gyroscopes used in the apparatus are powered directly by a wireless power transmission arrangement without the need for batteries. However, such an

apparatus nevertheless preferably includes batteries to provide a backup power supply.

(31) In certain embodiments, additional power supplementation is provided, such as through harnessing of light energy, electromagnetic radiation, thermal gradients and motion. Suitable arrangements include: Photovoltaics cells harvesting light energy lining the device surface, optionally with a transparent scratch resistant protective layer protecting the cells underneath; Thermoelectric generators exploiting thermal gradients established between body temperature and environment to generate electricity. Optionally, heat generated by motors can be used to establish thermal gradients in relation to a suitable cooling apparatus; Piezoelectric transducers which convert mechanical strain into current or voltage lining areas of the glove prone to deformation; Microfluidic energy harvesters generating electricity through conversion of kinetic energy in the form of vibration, shear and flow into electrical energy.

(32) Power generation through motion capture is considered to be of particular interest, particularly embedded microfluidic energy harvesting REWOD-based vibration harvesting. A REWOD process works by generating electricity as a conductive droplet changes position or shape, and thereby its area and position of contact with two oppositely charged dielectric coated electrodes. One design incorporating multiple harvesters encompasses one or more of: Conductive fluid droplets (e.g., Galinstan) between oscillating plates reclaiming energy from the vibrations of motors; Flexible fluidic chambers incorporated into the palmar aspect of a glove (for example) with fluidic channels lined with associated electrodes running along the dorsal aspect of apparatus; Piezoelectric transducers at palmar surface harnessing energy expended during grip; Sliding electrodes harnessing material shear along the wrist joint by enabling conductive fluid droplets to shear along the electrodes.

(33) Through harnessing ambient energy, it becomes possible for the apparatus to achieve autonomous power generation.

(34) The apparatus may further include current or voltage modulation circuitry to allow variation of the speed of rotation of the gyroscope disc **20,51** to allow for additional adjustment and fine tuning of the gyroscopic torque. In the preferred embodiments including telecommunications modules, fine tuning of the device through current or voltage adjustment can be achieved remotely, for example, by means of a computer, such as a computer operated remotely by a clinician, or by means of a portable device, preferably a touch-screen device, for ease of use by the patient, such as a smartphone or tablet computer. This feature allows for the incorporation of additional functionality and monitoring into the application or program running on the device, such as the display of system information and health metrics; and to allow for user customisation and programming.

(35) In certain embodiments, the housing for the gyroscope is sealed and the cavity filled with a gas at a density less than that of atmospheric air or the cavity is under vacuum, to reduce air resistance upon the rotating gyroscope, thereby reducing power draw and increasing efficiency and reliability.

(36) Although illustrated thus far with one or two gyroscopes, the present invention provides apparatus with any number of gyroscopes, to take account, for example, of tremor on a plurality of axes.

(37) As is shown in FIGS. **5A, 5B, 5C** and **6**, in preferred embodiments, the gyroscope disc **51** is advantageously formed with fracture lines **53** and/or fingers **54**. Fracture lines **53** form lines of weakness in the disc structure such that, in the event of damage to the gyroscope causing damage to the disc, such as might follow a fall against a hard surface, the disc is encouraged to fracture in a controlled manner. This reduces the likelihood of disc fragments breaching the containment of the cap **43** or the entire housing, mounting and glove.

(38) Additionally, the gyroscope may be constructed with a braking system, to provide rapid deceleration of the disc, both for use and safety reasons. Regenerative braking is preferred to supplement the power supply of the device.

(39) As shown in FIG. **6**, formation of gyroscope disc **51** with a plurality of fingers **54**, allows

adjustment of the legs to adjust the radial dimensions of the disc **51**, thereby adjusting the torque profile of the gyroscope. The radial extent of each leg **54** may be adjusted to increase the diameter of the disc as a whole or individual legs may be adjusted to give fine adjustment to the characteristics of the gyroscopic device. This method of adjusting the characteristics of a gyroscope forms a distinct and general aspect of the present invention.

(40) In preferred embodiments, such as those shown in FIG. **6** and in FIG. **8A** through FIG. **8D** described below, the fingers have an additional elastic component that induces contraction to the rotational axis in the event of failure, thereby further reducing the risk of fracture components breaching the housing. Suitably, the elastic component is formed by an elastic polymeric material or one or more springs.

(41) In preferred embodiments, additional stability is provided to the fingers by means of a resistive control device, for example resistive bands or dampers such as is shown in FIG. **7**, in which magnetorheological fluid dampers **55** are used, disposed about the upper surface of the glove. Such elements may also be mounted about the lower and side surfaces, as required by the requirements of the patient's treatment. These resistive methods can couple the fingers to the main gyroscope housing **42** for additional control of tremor. The elements of the resistive control device can be housed within a separate layer from the gyroscopic units or as components of the gyroscopic housings.

(42) FIGS. **8A** through **8D** show two variations of a modified gyroscope disc **51** in the form of a disc **60** having spaced upper and lower surfaces **61**, **62** and a plurality of apertures **63** disposed circumferentially about an outer surface of the disc **60**. Each aperture **63** is adapted to receive a peg **64**, which adds mass to the disc, principally to a radially outward portion, thereby providing an alternative mode for adjusting the torque characteristics of the gyroscope. This method of adjusting the characteristics of a gyroscope forms a distinct and general aspect of the present invention.

(43) FIGS. **9** to **13** schematically show various gyroscope arrangements. The various components are represented schematically, not literally. FIG. **9** shows a conventional construction in which gyroscope disc **70** is coupled by a shaft **71** to a brushed or brushless DC motor **72**. In FIG. **10**, the assembly has been made more compact by mounting motor **82** within a central circular aperture formed within disc **80**. Motor **82** is arranged to drive disc **80** through a transmission wheel or gear **81**.

(44) In the embodiment of FIG. **11**, disc **90** is directly formed integrated with the motor **91**. In the gyroscope of FIG. **12**, the gyroscope itself is effectively the motor. Gyroscope disc **100** is mounted centrally within the gyroscope and has a plurality of magnets **101** of alternating polarity mounted about its outer circumference. The assembly is mounted within an annulus of alternating field windings **102** with field poles **103** mounted within a frame **104**. Gyroscope disc **100** acts as the rotor of the motor and is caused to rotate by means of a correspondingly alternating polarity of the windings **102** in a conventional manner. The embodiment of FIG. **13** works as a motor in the same way as the embodiment of FIG. **12** save that disc **110** with annular alternating polarity magnets **111** has a central aperture **112** through which coil windings **113** pass, which windings are coupled by leads **114** to the electrical supply.

(45) In certain preferred embodiments, the apparatus includes a heat management system to remove heat generated by the spinning gyroscopes. Suitably, the heat management system includes the use of heat-dispersing housings to the gyroscopes. Preferably, the housings include a heat sink arrangement to enhance heat removal. Conveniently, the wearable device, such as a glove, includes heat channelling to disperse heat to the glove, thereby allowing the glove to warm a user's hands, in use. Advantageously, a thermally reflective lining is applied between the gyroscopic devices and the wearable element to reflect heat away from the wearer's body, thereby avoiding localised heating and allowing the heat management system to provide managed warming of the body.

(46) In preferred embodiments, the apparatus of the present invention includes additional functionality, in particular telemetries to provide feedback to a clinician on the operation of the

apparatus and monitoring of other parameters of the body, such as blood pressure, pulse, temperature and skin conductivity (such as would vary with sweating et cetera). Additionally, global positioning functionality (GPS) is optionally provided, preferably along with tracking functionality such that patients with additional health concerns such as dementia can be tracked using the apparatus. In certain preferred embodiments, the apparatus incorporates one or more accelerometer devices. These will detect a sudden significant movement of the wearer, such as in the case of a fall.

(47) Preferably, the apparatus further includes a telecommunications module, such as Wi-Fi®, Bluetooth®, GSM, GPRS, 3G, 4G and their developments).

(48) Thereby, data from the apparatus can be communicated back to a clinician or career or, in potentially life-threatening cases such as a fall or loss of a pulse, to the emergency services or other emergency contacts. The constructional and programming details of such additional functionality will be readily apparent to the skilled person and will not be described in further detail here.

(49) Thus, the apparatus can also be used clinically to monitor the progress of a degenerative disease such as Parkinson's Disease where tremors can vary on a daily basis; and to monitor the effectiveness in alleviation of the symptoms of the disease by medication or following surgical or other techniques. It can also be used to track the general health and wellbeing of the wearer.

(50) Further modifications to the apparatus include the inclusion of near field communication functionality. Common social activities requiring fine motor skill, such as retrieving coins and notes for payment at a cashier are difficult for individuals with Parkinson's Disease, Essential Tremor or other musculoskeletal conditions and significant stigma or simply frustration or embarrassment can attach to these conditions. Near field communication can be built into the device and programmed by suitable computer, tablet or smartphone connectivity, for example, to allow for contactless payment and other payment systems, such as Apple Pay or Google Wallet. Further integration with other devices can be included, such as with brain pacemakers.

(51) Remote monitoring functionality helps reduce costs of healthcare and increases convenience for users, especially non-mobile patients. With GPS functionality, the device can also act as a position tracker, to determine the location of the patient.

(52) Although principally described with respect to stabilisation of hand tremors, the apparatus of the present invention is equally suitable for other parts of the body, including the head, legs and arms, both singly and in combination using a plurality of apparatus.

(53) The apparatus can be used in tracking tremors, for example in physiotherapy and in training situations—surgical, sports and other applications.

(54) The following statements summarise optional additional components of an apparatus and their advantages: 1. Social interaction functions—sounds, voice and video communications, vibration, squeezing/pressure, warmth. If a child thinks of a grandparent, or users think of each other, they either squeeze the device, associated device, smartwatch, or send a smartphone alert, which initiates pressure, warmth with possible addition of alerts, voice and video communications. Potentially helps prevent isolation, loneliness, cognitive decline et cetera. 2. Memory storage within device: a. Entertainment, b. Contacts, c. Emergency calls e.g. with hotkeys, d. Agenda, appointments, schedules, reminders. 3. Gyroscope speed sensors (phonic wheel, optical tachometers, stroboscopes) which are distinct from intelligent speed controls. Allows tracking of gyroscope speeds and subsequently ties with user adjustability. Also allows inclusion of control means to reduce power draw and increase efficiency. Intelligent speed controls both autonomously and in conjunction with manual control and user settings. 4. Smartphone apps and other user interfaces—including peripheral applications such as medicine tracking, brain pacemaker integration. 5. Speaker and microphone. a. Social, i. 2 way communication between user and permissible parties, b. Safety. 6. Means of alerting user, including flashing lights, vibrations, piezo electric devices. a. User alerts, b. Encourage movement for health risks, c. Physiotherapy, and training for other applications. 7. Physiotherapy. 8. SIM card—for telecommunications and data

transfer in the event of wireless network protocol unavailability. 9. Safety features and casing functions—water-proofing, weather-sealing or high ingress protection rating, shock absorption, sound proofing. 10. Solar charging. 11. Remote server and cloud storage, transmission and sync services. a. Sync smart devices, b. Health professionals, c. Secure access and transmission of data. (55) Although the apparatus of the present invention has been described primarily with respect to therapeutic benefits for suffers of neurological conditions inducing relatively strong tremors, the present invention is equally suitable for other uses where stabilisation of hand vibrations (for example), such as those at a normal level caused simply by pulsation of blood flow would be beneficial, such as in sports (such as archery, darts or golf); fine arts, such as painting fine detail; photography or in surgery. (56) For the avoidance of doubt, features or aspects of the present invention which are described herein with respect to a specific embodiment are not limited to that embodiment. (57) The features described may be combined in any combination. Any and all such combinations are encompassed by the invention and shall not and do not constitute added subject matter.

Claims

1. An apparatus comprising: a gyroscope element having a gyroscope axis about which the gyroscope element rotates; a gyroscope mount member configured to mount the gyroscope element; wherein the gyroscope element is mounted to the gyroscope mount member to allow the gyroscope element to rotate about the gyroscope axis; a hinge; and a hinge plate to which the gyroscope mount member is mounted via the hinge; wherein the hinge plate is configured to mount to a first mount on a wearable element; wherein the hinge plate is configured to rotate with respect to the first mount of the wearable element so as to allow the gyroscope axis, via rotation of the hinge and the hinge plate, to precess relative to the wearable element.
2. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising at least one of: i) an accelerometer; ii) a fall sensor, iii) a sleep sensor, iv) a body metrics sensor, v) a blood pressure sensor, vi) a pulse sensor, vii) a temperature sensor, viii) a skin conductivity sensor, and ix) a sweat sensor.
3. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising: a battery power supply mounted to the wearable element; and a connector connecting the battery power supply with a motor configured to drive the gyroscope element to rotate about the gyroscope axis.
4. The apparatus as claimed in claim 3, wherein the connector is formed integrally with the wearable element.
5. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, wherein the wearable element includes a gyroscope-receiving cup.
6. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a gyroscope housing for the gyroscope element.
7. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first mount is formed integrally with the wearable element.
8. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, wherein the hinge plate comprises the hinge to which the gyroscope element is mounted via a connection at the gyroscope axis.
9. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first mount comprises a turntable to which the hinge plate is mounted so as to allow the hinge plate to rotate with respect to the wearable element.
10. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a control arrangement to control a precession of the gyroscope axis of the gyroscope element; and wherein the control arrangement comprises a plurality of elastomeric dampers.
11. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a control arrangement to control a precession of the gyroscope axis of the gyroscope element; and wherein the control arrangement comprises a magnetic control arrangement comprising at least one magnetic disc or annular magnet associated with the gyroscope element.

12. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a control arrangement to control a precession of the gyroscope axis of the gyroscope element; and wherein the control arrangement comprises a stepped motor and gear arrangement.
 13. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a battery power supply.
 14. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, wherein the gyroscope element is powered wirelessly and the apparatus further comprises a wireless power control circuit.
 15. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising a plurality of gyroscope elements; wherein the plurality of gyroscope elements comprises the gyroscope element and at least one additional gyroscope element; wherein the plurality of gyroscopes elements are distributed across at least one surface of the wearable element, and wherein each gyroscope element of the plurality of gyroscope elements is substantially associated with a tremor axis of a patient.
 16. The apparatus as claimed in claim 1, further comprising: i) adjustment means for adjusting or modulating a current through a motor or voltage applied to the motor, the motor configured to drive the gyroscope element to rotate about the gyroscope axis; ii) a global positioning system and tracking function; iii) wireless networking functionality linkable to external computer-based systems; iv) a heat-management arrangement comprising a heat-conductive casing; vi) autonomous power generation for the gyroscope element comprising at least one of: a) conductive fluid droplets between oscillating plates reclaiming energy from vibrations of motors; b) flexible fluidic chambers incorporated into a palmar aspect of the wearable element with fluidic channels lined with associated electrodes running along a dorsal aspect of the wearable element; c) piezoelectric transducers at a palmar surface to harness, in use, energy expended during gripping; and d) sliding electrodes harnessing material shear along a wrist joint by enabling conductive fluid droplets to shear along electrodes.
 17. A method comprising: controlling, by a control circuit, a motor arrangement connected to a gyroscope element comprising a gyroscope disc to compensate for tremors; wherein controlling the motor arrangement drives the gyroscope element to rotate about a gyroscope axis; wherein the gyroscope axis precesses with respect to a wearable element via a gyroscope mount member; wherein the gyroscope mount member comprises a hinge to which the gyroscope element is mounted; wherein the hinge is mounted to a hinge plate that is configured to mount to a mount on the wearable element, wherein the hinge plate is configured to allow the gyroscope axis to precess, via rotation of the hinge and the hinge plate, with respect to the mount of the wearable element; and wherein the hinge plate is attached to the wearable element.
 18. The method as claimed in claim 17, further comprising: receiving, by the control circuit, sensor signal from at least one sensor comprising at least one: i) an accelerometer; ii) a fall sensor, iii) a sleep sensor, iv) a body metrics sensor, v) a blood pressure sensor, vi) a pulse sensor, vii) a temperature sensor, viii) a skin conductivity sensor, and ix) a sweat sensor; and controlling, by the control circuit, the motor arrangement based at least in part on the sensor signal.
 19. The method as claimed in claim 17, further comprising controlling, by the control circuit, the motor arrangement by controlling at least one of a voltage and a current through the motor arrangement.
 20. The method as claimed in claim 17, further comprising controlling, by the control circuit, a plurality of elastomeric dampers to cause the gyroscope axis to precess with respect to the wearable element.
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